

Question 14 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse the changing role of an HRD professional as organisations move from traditional personnel administration toward strategic human resource development.

Answer

The HRD role has shifted from administrative trainer to strategic business partner and change agent.

- 1. From record-keeper to diagnostician:** Earlier focus on training calendars and files; now diagnosis of capability versus strategy.
- 2. From classroom organiser to learning architect:** Designing blended, on-the-job, coaching and e-learning systems, not only courses.
- 3. From isolated training cell to integrator:** Linking appraisal, potential, career, feedback and OD into one HRD system.
- 4. Business literacy:** The professional must understand markets, technology and strategy to align development.
- 5. Partner to line and top management:** Influencing decisions on structure, culture and talent, not waiting for training requests.
- 6. Change and OD role:** Facilitating mergers, digitalisation and culture change through people processes.
- 7. Metrics and accountability:** Using evaluation, climate surveys and HRD audit to show impact, not activity counts.
- 8. Ethical and employee-advocate role:** Balancing organisational strategy with employee growth and fairness—more complex than old personnel welfare.

Conclusion. The changing role demands higher competence: consulting, analytics, facilitation and strategic thinking, far beyond traditional personnel administration.